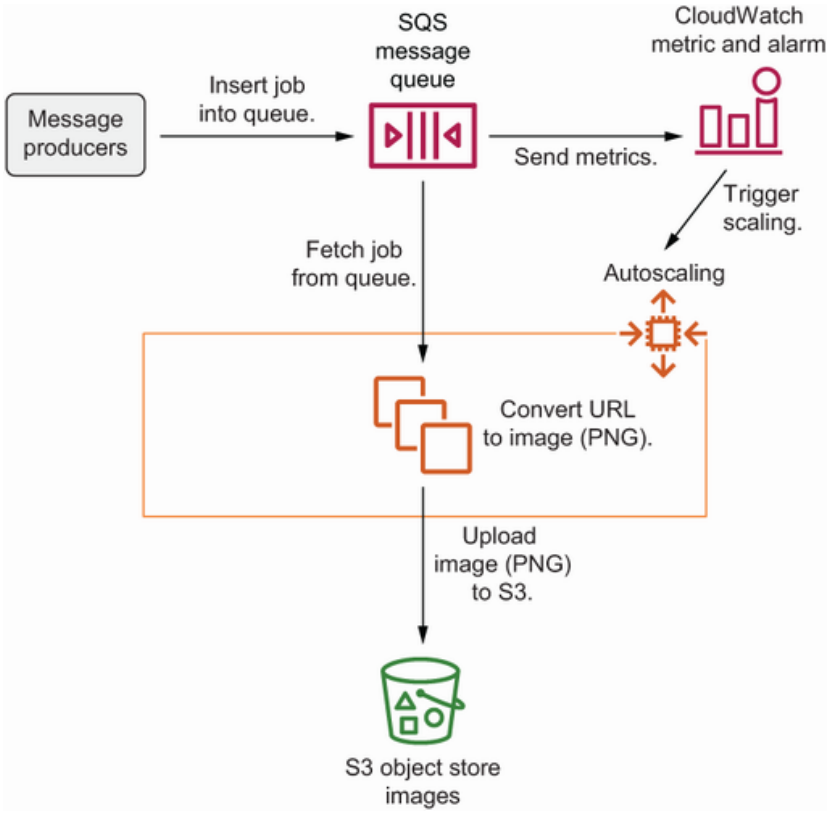


Figure 17.7 Autoscaling virtual machines that convert URLs into images, decoupled by an SQS queue

A CloudWatch alarm is used to monitor the length of the SQS queue. If the length of the queue reaches five, an additional virtual machine is started to handle the workload. When the queue length goes below five, another CloudWatch alarm decreases the desired capacity of the Auto Scaling group.

The code is in the book's code repository on GitHub at https://github.com/AWSinAction/code3. The CloudFormation template for the URL2PNG example is located at chapter17/url2png.yaml.

Execute the following command to create a CloudFormation stack that spins up the URL2PNG application:

```
$ aws cloudformation create-stack --stack-name url2png \
➥ --template-url https:/ /s3.amazonaws.com/\
➥ awsinaction-code3/chapter17/url2png.yaml \
➥ --capabilities CAPABILITY_IAM
```